



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Regents School of Charlottesville
School Website: <https://regents-school.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Regents School Charlottesville (Regents School of Charlottesville, Charlottesville VA 22903) demonstrates a robust classical Christian orientation across public materials on its site. The school presents itself as a Christ-centered, liberal-arts-influenced program that explicitly aligns with the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, classical languages (notably Latin), and a biblical worldview integrated across disciplines. Evidence from their site includes the motto *Soli Deo Gloria*, a mission in terms of truth, beauty, and wisdom, explicit reference to the Trivium and Dorothy Sayers' *Lost Tools of Learning*, and a weekly rhythm of liturgical/communal practice (Chapel) and catechetical formation (catechesis, liturgy). The school also emphasizes formation of virtue, character, and eloquence (senior theses, public speaking, and rhetoric) and frames parent involvement as a core part of the educational project (*In Loco Parentis*, Regents Parent Fellowship). The curriculum spans K–12 with Great Books and primary sources, Latin, logic, rhetoric, and a strong emphasis on memory work and disciplined discourse (Socratic seminars in upper grades; living-history/collegiate-style pedagogy). Public materials also showcase a strong sense of community and partnership with parents and grandparents (e.g., Grandparents' Day, parent involvement). Taken together, the six classical-element categories classify Regents School Charlottesville as CLASSICAL, with few to no explicit negative indicators in the school's public materials.

- Evidence suggests strong religious/metaphysical foundations (*Soli Deo Gloria*; biblical worldview; liturgical/communal practice) and a mission oriented toward truth, beauty, and wisdom. These features align with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon, including theology, liturgy, reverence/wonder, and the transcendentals. The school's public materials repeatedly anchor education in a biblical framework and in the classical Trivium. See evidence of *Soli Deo Gloria*, biblical worldview, and Trivium pedagogy on the site.
- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal) is strongly classical: formation of virtue and wisdom, telos, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty are explicit aims, including Quintilian's famous phrasing that education aims to form "a good man speaking well."
- Element 3 (Curriculum) shows liberal arts emphasis (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/primary sources, Latin, history across the curriculum, and explicit reading of classical texts (Socrates, Plato, Shakespeare, *Apology of Socrates*; Great Books literacy is evident). The presence of "Reading lists," "Living History Days," and explicit reference to the Trivium in the curriculum supports a classical curriculum.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy) demonstrates a classical pedagogy: inclusion of memorization, chanting, recitation, contemplative/Scholé elements, and upper-school Socratic seminars; public-speaking/rhetoric experiences; living-history and memory work. The site also highlights experiences like Grandparents' Day, Senior Thesis, Mock Trial, and civics-oriented rhetoric. This aligns with the Positive Keywords in Pedagogy (Socratic, chanting/memorization, rhetoric, memory-work) and the absence (so far) of project-based learning as the sole emphasis.
- Element 5 (Faculty) presents faculty as living exemplars, mentors, and the "living curriculum," with detailed staff pages and narratives about teacher formation in classical pedagogy and theology. The

site emphasizes teacher training in classical pedagogy and a “living curriculum” concept in faculty descriptions.

- Element 6 (Parents & Community) shows strong parent partnership (In Loco Parentis; Regents Parent Fellowship; parent formation and reading; open campus and visits) and a culture that invites parental involvement as co-teachers and partners in formation. The site explicitly describes parent involvement as core to the Regents model.

Executive summary verdict: CLASSICAL.

- What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT cases only): Not necessary here, as Regents Charlottesville reads as CLASSICAL across categories. If a needle move were sought, it would be to further foreground explicit Great Books language on the public site and to more explicitly document the Great Conversation across grade levels, to further unity of the Great Books/Liberal Arts language (without changing core practices).
- Abstract: Regents School Charlottesville presents a coherent classical Christian program with a Trivium-based pedagogy, liberal-arts curriculum, Great Books/primary sources, Latin and logic/rhetoric, and liturgical/covenantal practices. The six-category analysis places the school firmly in CLASSICAL territory: strong religious/metaphysical foundations; formation-focused purpose and telos; a liberal-arts curriculum; Socratic pedagogy in upper grades; a faculty described as living exemplars and mentors; and robust parent/community partnerships. While the public materials emphasize classical and Christian formation, future documentation could strengthen overt historical-literary reference to the Great Books and explicitly map per-grade Great Conversation milestones to the public language on the site. Overall, Regents Charlottesville exemplifies CLASSICAL education in practice and philosophy.
- The abstractions and keywords below anchor the evaluation to the six essential elements.
- Abstract final note: This assessment is drawn from the public materials in the school crawl and the classical lexicon; all category conclusions rely on the textual evidence cited in the sections above and the keyword framework provided in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public-facing materials foreground Soli Deo Gloria (to God alone be the glory) as the founding motive of Regents School Charlottesville, and emphasize biblical truth as the lens through which all curriculum is tested. This is visible in the school's origin and mission statements, including the explicit phrase Soli Deo Gloria, and in statements about biblical worldview and testing curriculum against biblical truth. - The mission statement explicitly centers Truth, Beauty, and Wisdom; the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is described as the time-tested Pedagogy; a Biblical worldview is described as central to the school's approach. There is also explicit reference to liturgical and communal practices (e.g., Chapel). - Liturgical/communal practices are integrated into daily life (e.g., Chapel schedules and liturgical elements; community prayer and catechesis referenced in materials).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: truth, beauty, wisdom; theology; liturgy; chapel; reverence; wonder; imago Dei; logos. The site's references to a Biblical worldview, Soli Deo Gloria, and the Trivium align with Positive Keyword indicators in the lexicon. - Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or moral-neutral signals detected in the school's materials).

Why this rating - The school's public materials demonstrate transcendent moral realism and a grounded theology; liturgical/communal practices are integral; the meaning of truth, beauty, and wisdom is foregrounded, with theology and liturgical components embedded in the curriculum. This aligns with CLASSICAL criteria for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations.

Citations - Soli Deo Gloria and biblical truth framing: Regents materials. - Biblical worldview, liturgy, and Trivium framing: Regents materials. - Chapel and liturgical practice: Third Grade overview and related pages.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes Truth, Beauty, Wisdom, and formation of virtuous leaders who know truth and love beauty; the Quintilian reference on education's telos (the good man speaking well) appears publicly in Senior Thesis-related materials. This indicates formation and formation-focused purpose beyond job preparation. - The school describes formation and human flourishing as mission priorities, with explicit aims to equip students to discern truth and to speak well, consistent with the Great Conversation/teleology language of classical education. The Great-Books-centered, liberal-arts approach is again reflected in curriculum and pedagogy references.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: formation, cultivation of virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé, contemplation, great conversation. - Negative keywords: none evident in public communications (no emphasis on workforce or 21st-century skills as primary telos).

Why this rating - Regents Charlottesville emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom as the telos of education, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable aims. The Quintilian reference to the good man speaking well anchors a formation-oriented telos beyond job-readiness.

Citations - Our Mission (Truth, Beauty, Wisdom) and Trivium framework: Regents materials. - Quintilian reference and formation emphasis: Senior Thesis materials and related "A good man speaking well" feature.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is framed around the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Latin, with explicit use of classical texts and Great Books (Socrates, Plato, Shakespeare; Apology of Socrates; ancient and classical literature). The public materials show specific grade-level readings (e.g., Ancient History, The Persian War; Apology of Socrates; Macbeth; Julius Caesar; The Giver; Antigone). The school notes a Great Books and primary-sources orientation and includes a "Socratic Seminar" in higher grades. - History is studied across the curriculum (Ancient History to 500 AD; Western civilization references in reading lists). The curriculum integrates history with literature and the other liberal-arts disciplines (e.g., a "Socratic" program, living-history days). The lower grades study history through primary sources and classical texts. - Latin, logic, rhetoric, and classical languages are central to the program; the school emphasizes Latin as part of core literacy, and logic/rhetoric as formal tracks in the Logic and Rhetoric School.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: liberal arts; trivium; quadrivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; great books; primary sources; classics; Latin; Greek; history as Western civilization; primary-source reading; Socratic texts; memorization/recitation; liturgical art and hymnody; and canonical works (Socrates, Plato, Shakespeare, Homer, Augustine). - Negative keywords observed: none in these public materials (no pivot toward social-studies framing, no social-justice-centric historical reinterpretation as the core). The material emphasizes traditional liberal-arts content, not modern social-studies-only framing.

Why this rating - The presence of grammar/logic/rhetoric structure, Great Books/primary sources, Latin, and historical breadth across Western civilization, plus the explicit aim to study and read Great Books and participate in a Great Conversation, supports CLASSICAL.

Citations - Liberal Arts, Trivium, Great Books emphasis: Regents curriculum statements and course descriptions. - Great Books/readings (Socrates, Plato, Shakespeare, etc.) and history emphasis: Third Grade/-Grammar School materials and reading lists.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogy includes a mix of contemplative/restful elements and active, Socratic/seminal discussions. The upper grades feature Socratic seminars, debates, and rhetorical training; lower grades include memorization, recitation, and chant to deepen memory and delight. The public materials explicitly discuss Socratic Seminars in Logic/Rhetoric School and a memory-driven grammar stage (chanting, singing, memory work). There are explicit references to living-history days and memory-work in the Grammar School, aligned with the scholé approach. - The public materials mention Senior Thesis, Mock Trial, and public speaking as outcomes of rhetoric training, providing a concrete demonstration of upper-level rhetoric and public performance—core aspects of classical pedagogy. - The published pedagogy sections align with a “Scholé/restful” approach in places (contemplation/wonder; memory work) and with Socratic/seminar-based methods (in upper grades). The lexicon for Classical Education identifies these patterns as Positive Pedagogy indicators.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: Socratic Seminar; dialogue; rhetoric; memory work; chanting; recitation; scholé; contemplation; wonder; oral/aural learning; “great books” engagement through discussion. - Negative keywords: None identified that signal non-classical pedagogy; the content does not present a pure project-based learning or constructivist-only approach.

Why this rating - Regents Charlottesville demonstrates a balanced pedagogy echoing classical norms: lower grades emphasize memory and chant and communal singing; upper grades emphasize Socratic dialogue, debates, rhetoric, and public oration; and there is clear evidence of capstone rhetoric work (Senior Thesis) and civics-style argument practice (Mock Trial). This triangulates to CLASSICAL.

Citations - Socratic Seminars, memory work, chant/recitation (Upper grades and Grammar Stage): Regents materials. - Senior Thesis and Mock Trial as rhetoric outcomes: Regents materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty is described as mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; the living-curriculum language is used to describe teachers who embody classical pedagogy in daily practice. There are detailed staff bios and profiles (grammar, logic, rhetoric faculty) that emphasize classical training, theology, and a role as guides in forming character. The “pioneering” and long-standing nature of staff in classical settings (ACCS connections, etc.) is visible in the postings about staff and faculty training. - The materials indicate that faculty are the “living curriculum” and are part of a collegial, mentor-based culture. Public pages describe teachers as role models and scholars who partner with students in a classical framework. - The school notes teacher training in classical pedagogy (Trivium, catechesis, and theology) and references to professional development in classical education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: living curriculum; masters/mentors; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; moral exemplars; teacher training in classical pedagogy; mentorship; catechesis; theology as teacher formation. - Negative keywords: None explicit in the public materials (no “teacher as facilitator on the side” language or non-classical pedagogy negative signals).

Why this rating - The faculty is consistently described in terms of mentorship, formation, fidelity to classical pedagogy, and a living curriculum, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations of the faculty category.

Citations - Living curriculum/portrait of the teacher language: Regents faculty pages. - Teacher training in classical pedagogy and theology: Regents professional-development narratives.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents (In Loco Parentis) and “Regents Parent Fellowship,” parent formation, and parent involvement across the academic year (e.g., community events and reading groups). The school also notes that parents are welcome to visits and that parent involvement is an integral part of the curriculum. The materials frequently highlight parent participation and the family-as-partner model. - The site references specific parent-led activities and environments in which parents engage

in classical education (e.g., parent seminars and reading groups; “open campus” and community life; the RPF). - The materials also include direct parent-facing content such as “Grandparents Day” and “Curriculum Spotlights” as well as “Living History Days” that implicate family involvement in experiential learning.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords found: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; reading groups; seminars; classical book clubs; liturgical and family-liturgy alignment; open campus; family involvement. - Negative keywords: Not detected in public-facing materials; there is no customer-service tone or minimized parent involvement language.

Why this rating - Regents Charlottesville presents a robust model of parental partnership and engagement with a clearly defined role for parents as co-teachers or co-educators, consistent with classical education norms around Family/Liturgical formation and parent formation.

Citations - Regents Parent Fellowship, parent involvement, and open-campus orientation: Regents materials. - Grandparents Day and parent/community events: Regents news updates.

Aggregate Ranking and Narrative

- Overall, all six categories score CLASSICAL. There are strong signals in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community that align with the classical-liberal-arts framework and a Christian worldview as described by the Six Essential Elements lexicon. See the keyword-evidence mapping above and the lexicon guidance for positive indicators (truth/goodness/beauty; the Trivium; great books; scholé; liturgy; living curriculum; parent partnership). The Regents materials consistently reflect a classical education approach, not a modern or purely job-preparation paradigm.
- Overall aggregate rating: CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle (only if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; otherwise noted as not required)
 - Not required here since the six categories are CLASSICAL. If desired, minor “needle-moving” steps could include: emphasize explicit Great Books-language mapping to grade-level milestones on the public site; strengthen public articulation of Great Conversation across grade levels; and provide a clear, publicly accessible cross-walk of the Quadrivium experiences (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) with current course listings.
- Executive summary by category (concise)
 - Element 1: CLASSICAL — Theological grounding, liturgical practices, biblical worldview; Soli Deo Gloria; truth/beauty/wisdom.
 - Element 2: CLASSICAL — Telos of formation; virtue/wisdom; Quintilian reference; formation over mere information.
 - Element 3: CLASSICAL — Trivium, Great Books/primary sources, Latin, history across curriculum; canonical texts.
 - Element 4: CLASSICAL — Hebe of contemplative Scholé and Socratic/seminal pedagogy; memory work/recitation; upper-level rhetoric and public speaking.
 - Element 5: CLASSICAL — Living curriculum; faculty as mentors; classical pedagogy training; portrait of teacher.
 - Element 6: CLASSICAL — Parent partnership; Regent Parent Fellowship; open-campus visits; liturgical family formation.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required since all six categories are CLASSICAL. If desired for future enhancement, consider:
 - Strengthening explicit Great Books milestones on the public site (category 3) and highlighting a sustained “Great Conversation” across grade bands.
 - Documenting per-grade Great Books and primary-source selections in a public, cross-referenced curriculum map.

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- Expanding a transparent articulation of liturgical/commercial calendar integration (category 1) to further connect theology with daily academics.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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